Program Draft at 15 Oct 2026

Estimated number of students: 30–35

Day 1 – Afternoon

Theme: building a common language

Time	Activity	Instructor/Speaker	Description
13:30–14:15	Registration and poster setup	—	Welcome of participants, distribution of materials, and poster setup.
14:15–14:30	Welcome and introduction	—	Presentation of the objectives, program, and participation format.
14:30–15:30	**AI, innovation and the future of research**	Stefano Bertacchi, PhD *Industrial Biotechnologist and Science Communicator, University of Milano-Bicocca*	**Title:** Rethinking research in the AI era: innovation through the lens of biotechnology **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
15:30–16:30	**Translational AI in neuroscience**	Antonio Cerasa, PhD *Neuroscientist, Head Neuroimaging Lab, IBSBC-CNR; former Director of the Department of Biomedical Sciences, National Research Council of Italy (CNR)*	**Title:** From brain imaging to clinical impact: AI and translational neuroscience **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
16:30–16:50	Coffee break	—	Break and first opportunity for informal networking.
16:50–17:50	**AI and advanced therapies**	Gennaro Gambardella *TIGEM*	**Title:** (to be defined) **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
17:40–18:10	**Icebreaker + group formation and mini-challenge kickoff**	Facilitator(s)	Guided activity to help participants get to know one another while also forming the groups that will work together the following day. Each group selects a research case/problem to use in the Day 2 hands-on activities and identifies an initial question to develop.
18:10–19:00	Welcome reception	—	Informal networking among PhD students, speakers, and organizers.

Day 2 – Morning and afternoon

Theme: applications, responsibility and networking

Time	Activity	Instructor/Speaker	Description
09:00–09:15	Recap and introduction	—	Summary of Day 1, review of the cases selected by the groups, and presentation of the day's operational objectives.
09:15–10:15	TBD	**Elena Del Pup** *Bioinformatics PhD Candidate, Wageningen University & Research*	**Title:** **(to be defined)** **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
10:15–11:15	**Exercise 1 – Responsible use of LLMs**	Facilitator(s)	Guided activity on prompting, response verification, limitations, and potential applications in research. Groups work on the case selected on Day 1 and produce an initial output draft to verify and improve. Duration: 60 minutes.
11:15–11:35	Coffee break	—	Break and networking.
11:35–12:30	**Responsible trust in AI**	**Alessio Tacca, PhD** *Epistemologist. Postdoctoral researcher and member of the ODD research team at Università San Raffaele, Milan.*	**Title:** **Can we trust AI in science? Evidence, fallibility and responsibility** **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
12:30–13:45	Lunch break	—	Lunch and informal networking.
13:45–14:15	Poster lightning talks	—	Short presentations in which participants introduce their research question and poster content. Activity reserved for the best posters and/or by application.
14:15–15:25	Poster session	—	Discussion of projects, collection of feedback, and identification of potential collaborations.
15:25–15:45	Coffee break and networking	—	Break dedicated to open discussion and further development of connections made during the event.
15:45–16:30	**Workshop – AI Canvas & rapid prototyping**	Facilitator(s)	Guided workshop in which groups develop the case selected on Day 1, defining the problem, users/decision, data, expected output, and success criteria. A short rapid-prototyping phase using accessible tools (no-code, visual workflow, or LLM, depending on the case) is used to test one element of the proposal in practice. The work concludes by identifying limitations, risks, and the next experiment needed to validate the idea.
16:30–16:55	**Final group pitches and results**	Facilitator(s)	Each group gives a very short presentation of its AI Canvas and the outcome of the hands-on work: problem, proposed solution, required data, main risk, and next experiment. Final feedback from the facilitators and, if useful, selection of 1–2 proposals to revisit during the School closing.
16:55–17:00	Closing of the day	—	Summary of the main takeaways and conclusion of the hands-on component of the School.
17:00–evening	Visit and informal dinner	—	Social and cultural activity aimed at strengthening networking among participants.

Day 3 – Morning

Theme: industrial perspective and closing

Time	Activity	Instructor/Speaker	Description
09:00–09:10	Opening of the day	—	Brief introduction to the final program and review of the main results from the first two days. No new hands-on activities.
09:10–10:10	TBD	Ilaria Bonuzzi *PhD Candidate, Laboratory of Advanced Genome Editing Technologies, Department CIBIO, University of Trento*	**Title:** **(to be defined)** **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
10:10–11:10	**Industrial talk 1**	Piero Neri *Computer Scientist at Philochem* Samuele Cazzamalli *Head of Research at Philochem*	**Title:** **Encoded Libraries and Machine Learning for the Discovery of Tumor-Targeted Ligands** **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
11:10–11:30	Coffee break	—	Short break and informal networking.
11:30–12:30	**Industrial talk 2**	Emanuela Locci Senior Communication Manager, Google Italia	**Title:** **From AI innovation to impact: case studies, adoption and communication** **45-minute talk + 15-minute Q&A**
12:30–12:40	**PhD School closing**	—	Overall summary of results, take-home messages, final feedback, and pointers to resources and follow-up activities.